Richard Dillman

Engineering Leader · Scaling Teams & Systems

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Summary

Hands-on engineering leader who builds high-traffic web platforms and the teams behind them. Rose from Senior Application Engineer to Senior Director of Engineering at The Muse, promoted 6 engineers to senior or lead roles, and generated $994K in annualized new ad revenue by launching on-site advertising. At Talent.com, restored Google Jobs indexing from zero to 1.5M+ jobs a day and raised test coverage from 59% to 91%. Comfortable shipping to platforms with millions of monthly users. Open to full-time and fractional engineering leadership roles.

Skills

Leadership: Engineering Leadership · Mentoring and Career Growth · Technical Strategy · Platform Modernization · PRDs and RFCs · AI-Assisted Development
Platform: TypeScript · React · Next.js · Node.js · Python · PostgreSQL · AWS · Kubernetes · Kafka · Datadog · Grafana
SEO and Growth: Technical SEO · Structured Data · Google Search Console · Core Web Vitals

Work Experience

Talent.com **Dec 2025 - Present**

12M monthly unique visitors, 70M monthly page views, 46.8M active jobs

Staff Software Engineer Dec 2025 - Present

Embedded with a 10-engineer team: find the highest-cost problems, write the fix plan, and route each fix to the team's engineers or ship it directly.

- Identified $60K/year in recoverable Google Geocoding spend, confirmed by Finance, in a location service consolidation PRD.
- Measured 45% duplication across job data sources and drove a cross-team decision to show one copy of each job without losing revenue.
- Restored Google Jobs indexing from zero to 1.5M+ new jobs a day by proving 15.9M rejections came from a daily quota, not a rate limit.
- Raised jobseeker test coverage from 59% to 91% and shipped a staged upgrade (Next.js 15, Nx 22, React 19, next-intl v4) with zero production regressions.
- Migrated 4 frontends to a new authentication library behind a dual-implementation flag with zero auth downtime.
- Launched a team-shared AI engineering platform of 59 Claude Code skills and 21 agents, with multi-agent code review on every merge request, and seven other engineers have contributed to it.

The Muse **Dec 2018 - Sep 2025**

16M monthly users

Senior Director of Engineering Apr 2024 - Sep 2025

- Led a 15-engineer team and promoted 6 engineers to senior or lead roles through mentorship and quarterly growth reviews.
- Increased ad revenue 15% by migrating to Raptive with improved layouts and formats.
- Increased job applications per user 50% by redesigning search into a two-pane layout with inline browsing.
- Increased article-to-marketplace conversions 138% with a Trending Search module, and Apply button CTR 22% through UX experiments.

- Launched Maya, The Muse's first AI content discovery tool, adding 3,500 article readers a month across 24K+ articles.

Director of Application Development — Dec 2023 - Mar 2024

- Generated $994K in annualized new ad revenue by launching on-site advertising with third-party vendors without slowing the site.
- Increased the job posting crawl budget 49K by converting links to non-indexed offsite pages into buttons.
- Reduced Interaction to Next Paint (INP) by 300ms through Google Tag Manager cleanup.

Staff Engineer — Apr 2021 - Nov 2023

- Architected a white-label, multi-tenant job search platform modeled at $153K-$230K annual revenue per partner tenant.
- Grew SEO visits 74K/month by replacing infinite scroll with server-side pagination.
- Increased job tile clicks 21.9% and views per user 20% with a search UX refresh that passed Core Web Vitals.
- Grew organic SEO traffic 10x with JSON-LD structured data and performance refactors.
- Cut build times from 45 minutes to 75 seconds by modularizing repos and rebuilding the CI/CD pipelines.

Senior Application Engineer — Dec 2018 - Mar 2021

- Cut new project setup from 2-3 weeks to 2-3 days with a Next.js, Koa, Docker, and CircleCI template adopted org-wide.
- Reduced regression bugs 30%+ by standardizing on ESLint, Jest, and Puppeteer and mentoring the team on them.

Condé Nast — **Jul 2015 - Nov 2018**

30+ brands, 229M monthly users, 1B+ monthly video views

Senior Software Engineer, Ad Tech and Monetization — Jul 2015 - Nov 2018

- Increased ad viewability from 45% to 85% by rebuilding ad infrastructure for 30+ global publications (Vogue, The New Yorker, Wired, GQ, Vanity Fair).
- Reached 80%+ test coverage across a 45-engineer editorial engineering org through standardized testing and documentation.